AI AT WORK · ONE-PAGE JOB AID

Five rules before you hit Enter

You don't need to be technical to use AI safely. These five rules cover most everyday situations. Your organisation's own AI policy always comes first.

The 10-second check, every time

- ☐ **Is this tool approved by my organisation?**
- ☐ **Have I removed personal and confidential details?**
- ☐ **Will I check the output before I use it?**

Any "no"? Stop and fix it first, or ask before you go ahead.

1 Protect data

Don't paste personal data (names, contact details, health or HR information) or confidential business information into a tool your organisation hasn't approved. GDPR still applies when you use AI.

ASK YOURSELF
Would I be comfortable if this text were stored outside the company?

2 Check before you use

AI predicts likely words; it doesn't look up the truth. Verify facts, figures, quotes and links. Open every source it gives you and confirm it says what the AI claims.

ASK YOURSELF
Have I opened the source, or am I trusting that it exists?

3 Be open

Say when content was made or heavily shaped by AI, especially text or images that people will rely on or that could be mistaken for real.

ASK YOURSELF
Would the reader feel misled if they learned AI wrote this?

4 A human decides

Never let AI make decisions about people, such as hiring, performance or customer complaints, on its own. AI can suggest; a person decides and is accountable.

ASK YOURSELF
If this decision is challenged, who explains it? It must be a person.

5 Speak up

If an AI tool gives a biased, harmful or badly wrong result, report it. Mistakes caught early are cheap.

ASK YOURSELF
Could this go wrong again for someone who doesn't notice?

Usually fine in any tool

- Public information, such as a published news article
- Generic questions, such as how to structure a project plan
- Your own wording to polish, with names and details removed

Only in approved tools, if at all

- Customer or employee names, emails, addresses, order history
- Health, HR or performance information
- Unannounced plans, deals, prices or financial results

Not sure? Treat it as confidential and ask.

Something looks wrong? Report it to: _____